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The affairs of Daura

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Dan Barau .—This was another office reserved for free men without lineage restriction. Its *kudin sarauta* varied between 300,000 and 500,000 cowries. Dan Barau lived in his family compound and had no territorial administrative powers. Besides presiding over palace protocol and the distribution of kola nuts at the chief's request, Dan Barau's main duty was to collect the grain tithe (*zakka*) throughout the chiefdom. This was organized through the *masugari* of all the rural communities, including the Maguzawa, Bugaje, and Fulani settlements. With the Sarkin Karma's escort, Dan Barau arranged to transport the *zakka* as it was needed to the palace, where the Dan Sanwai estimated its volume and divided it as the chief directed for distribution to the various officials of state, slave and free. Dan Barau had no seat on the lesser council, although he normally attended to distribute kola nuts before council sessions. At the chief's installation, he prepared the gifts of kola nuts for dispatch to neighboring chiefs. Since his official duty of collecting the *zakka* was highly profitable, the Dan Barau paid a *kudin sarauta* of 500,000 cowries and a proportionate *yankai* .

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Tarno .—This office was always reserved for the free son of a princess, usually the daughter or sister of the preceding or reigning chief. Thus Tarno and the chief were often cross-cousins and joking relations. Tarno was often, but by no means always, the son of a Dan Sanwai. Tarno had charge of all mat weavers, weavers of cloth, dyers, and dye beaters throughout the territory, and he collected their tax. In addition, he collected tax from the women hairdressers, keeping some and giving the chief the rest. Besides their individual tax, dyers paid a tax of 3,300 cowries per dye pit. Pits of similar design and type were also used by mat weavers in the dry season to preserve their straw against the dry wind, and all who owned a *diga* (weaving pit) were

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liable to tax. To assist him, Tarno appointed an Ubandawaki who supervised the affairs of the dyers and dye beaters. Tarno seems to have dealt with the mat weavers, cloth weavers and female hairdressers directly himself. He also collected taxes from tailors and embroiderers. The office had no state compound or fiefs; and Tarno had no seat on any state council. Being outside the royal lineage, Tarno was not subject to the Galadima but had a special place among the chief's courtiers. From his levies on the clothworkers, Tarno was required to supply the Sarkin Jarmai with sufficient cloth for the quilted cotton armor which the slave *lifida* prepared under the direction of the Sarkin Jarmai and Sarkin Lifidi. Although Tarno's office was especially lucrative, its *kudin sarauta* varied between 300,000 and 1,000,000 cowries according to the chief's inclination. In battle Tarno remained with the princes beside the Galadima in the rear.

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Barage .—This office was hereditary in a free lineage. Its holder administered the trade in potash and salt at the capital. Barage negotiated with visiting merchants to secure the necessary supplies of these two commodities. He  133 bought the chief's requirements in bulk and, as head of the local salt sellers, regulated its local price. In this capacity he collected an annual tax of 1,200 cowries from every salt seller. At the fast of Ramadan, the chief would give the Barage a large *kantu* (bundle) of salt for distribution within the city.

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